



INDUSTRY NEWS

MAKE IN INDIA

India's installed solar capacity reaches 20GW

India has achieved the milestone of 20GW in cumulative solar installations four years ahead of time, reports Mercom India Research. 20GW was the initial goal set up for 2022 by the National Solar Mission. The government is now working hard to achieve the revised target of 100GW solar by 2022.

According to Mercom, utility-scale cumulative installations total for India now stands at 18.4GW, with

rooftop solar accounting for another 1.6GW.

For the first time, solar was the top source of new power capacity additions in India during calendar year 2017, with preliminary figures gathered by Mercom showing that solar installations reached 9.6GW and accounted for 45 per cent of total capacity additions.

The top state for solar installations was Telangana, followed by Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Rajasthan.

Electronics manufacturing needs new talent: SEMI

SEMI, the global industry association representing the electronics manufacturing supply chain, has made an urgent call to overcome the pressing semiconductor industry challenge of recruiting new talent. In a letter to the CEOs of more than 2000 global SEMI member companies, Ajit Manocha, SEMI's president and CEO, called on the executives to act together to attract workers and develop the workforce vital to industry growth.

New talent is key to sustain-

ing robust growth that has broken all semiconductor industry records. Industry analysts at SEMI's Industry Strategy Symposium (ISS) had recently reported that semiconductor device (chip) revenues jumped 22 per cent to nearly \$450 billion in 2017. Semiconductor manufacturing equipment sales rose 36 per cent and, with materials, topped \$104 billion. In 2018, chip and semiconductor equipment revenues are forecast to increase 7 per cent and more than 11 per cent respectively.

Handset makers may invest ₹ 60 billion

India could see investments of up to \$900 million (about ₹ 60 billion) in the next two years from leading handset makers and global contract manufacturers that are seeking to increase the local content in their instruments by assembling printed circuit boards (PCBs) in the country—reports *Economic Times*.

Industry insiders say that Chinese handset makers such as Vivo, Oppo and OnePlus, besides Indian players

including Micromax and Lava, have earmarked higher investments to take advantage of the recently imposed duties on some components and the expected levy on imports of PCBs, which make up 50 per cent of the cost of making a mobile phone. Further investments are also planned by contract manufacturers such as Foxconn and Dixon. About 350 surface-mount technology (SMT) lines are expected to be set up by all key players.

On The Move

Yohida replaces Hirai as Sony CEO

Sony Corp CEO Kazuo Hirai has handed over the reins to finance chief Kenichiro Yoshida, who is known for his no-nonsense approach to restructuring after he became CFO in 2014. Hirai and Yoshida together streamlined Sony's unprofitable electronics businesses and then capitalised on the spread of smartphones with image sensors. Yoshida will be taking on the top job in April. Hirai, 57, will stay on as chairman.

Indian's Top Electronic Product Imports in 2016

According to information on www.worldstopexports.com, in 2016, Indian importers spent the most on the following 10 subcategories of electronics products:

1. Phone system devices including smartphones: US\$14.7 billion (up 66.1 per cent)
2. Solar power diodes/semiconductors: \$3.6 billion (up 313.5 per cent)
3. Unrecorded sound media: \$1.8 billion (down 20 per cent)
4. Integrated circuits/microassemblies: \$1.6 billion (up 8.6 per cent)
5. TV receivers/monitors/projectors: \$1.6 billion (up 68.8 per cent)
6. Electrical converters/power units: \$1.5 billion (up 43.6 per cent)
7. TV/radio/radar device parts: \$1.4 billion (up 39.7 per cent)
8. Lower-voltage switches, fuses: \$1.1 billion (up 42.6 per cent)
9. Insulated wires/cables: \$787.1 million (up 12.6 per cent)
10. Electric storage batteries: \$772.5 million (up 192.3 per cent)

Among these import subcategories, Indian purchases of solar power diodes and semiconductors, electric storage batteries, and TV receivers, monitors or projectors grew at the fastest pace from 2009 to 2016.